sale for a year and a half, having sold some 13,000 copies.

While in New York, I gave copies of the textbook to my parents and to the Blugermans. 4

I returned to Boston in time to catch the peak of a heat wave, with the temperature topping 100 on June 26. John left on the morning of the thirtieth.

My relations with Doubleday had become easygoing indeed. No more outlines, no more options, no more let-me-see-a-piece. I had merely to say I would do a new Space Ranger juvenile and that was enough. By July 5, 1952, Doubleday informed me that a contract and an advance were on the way.

I needed a new name for my hero, though. Starr was all right, but David was pedestrian. I couldn't change it but I could give him a nickname—and one seemed such a natural that it occurred to me at once and I never sought another. The second book was entitled, therefore, Lucky Starr and the Pirates of the Asteroids.

4 I did this routinely with every book I ever published. Almost the first thing I did when the author's copies came in was to mail one off to the Asimovs and one to the Blugermans. Each household gradually accumulated a fine library of Isaac Asimov books that threatened to push them out of house and home. Any suggestion that I stop overloading them, however, was met with instant indignation, and I could never stop.

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The year 1952, was, of course, a presidential election year, and it seemed to be a sure Republican year. This time, unlike 1948, there could be no mistake. For one thing, Truman was so unpopular that it was difficult to see how he could fail to be an albatross, dragging any Democratic candidate down to defeat. For another, it looked as though Eisenhower would be the Republican candidate, and, if so, he would be undefeatable. I hoped earnestly that the Republican Party regulars, who tried valiantly to commit electoral suicide, would put through Robert Taft as the nominee, but they didn't manage.

What I remember most clearly about the Republican convention was MacArthur's keynote speech. He had become the deified leader of America's conservatives after he had been justly fired by Truman, and there was some hope that he would stampede the convention into nominating him by a pyrotechnic display of eloquence. The speech, however, fell so incredibly flat that I said to Gertrude (as recorded in my diary), "He is stepping off the